RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

21 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 5:54 AM, Wednesday 21 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 120 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Disrupted** · 42 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 13,470 minutes at 6:00 AM (only movements since 3:00 AM: Saudia SV982 to Hong Kong 3:02 AM and non-airline HZA8 to Heraklion 4:33 AM); Dammam halted since 3:58 AM, 122 minutes

1

INCIDENT SUMMARY

What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 13,470 minutes at 6:00 AM; NOTAM A3650/26 still requires prior GACA permission for every flight**.
- Since 3:00 AM Riyadh had 2 takeoffs and no landings: delayed Saudia SV982 to Hong Kong at 3:02 AM and non-airline HZA8 to Heraklion at 4:33 AM; nothing since.
- 120 Wednesday Riyadh flights already cancelled (19%).
- No new attack on Saudi Arabia reported since 9 PM; Saudi envoy Al Jaber says the Kingdom will protect its people and territory (SABA, 4:20 AM).
- Dammam airport halted since 3:58 AM, 122 minutes at 6:00 AM (overnight lull); 3 landings and no takeoffs since 3:00 AM, last Air Arabia G9160 from Sharjah.

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (13465 min).

120	0/0	4
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

DISRUPTED

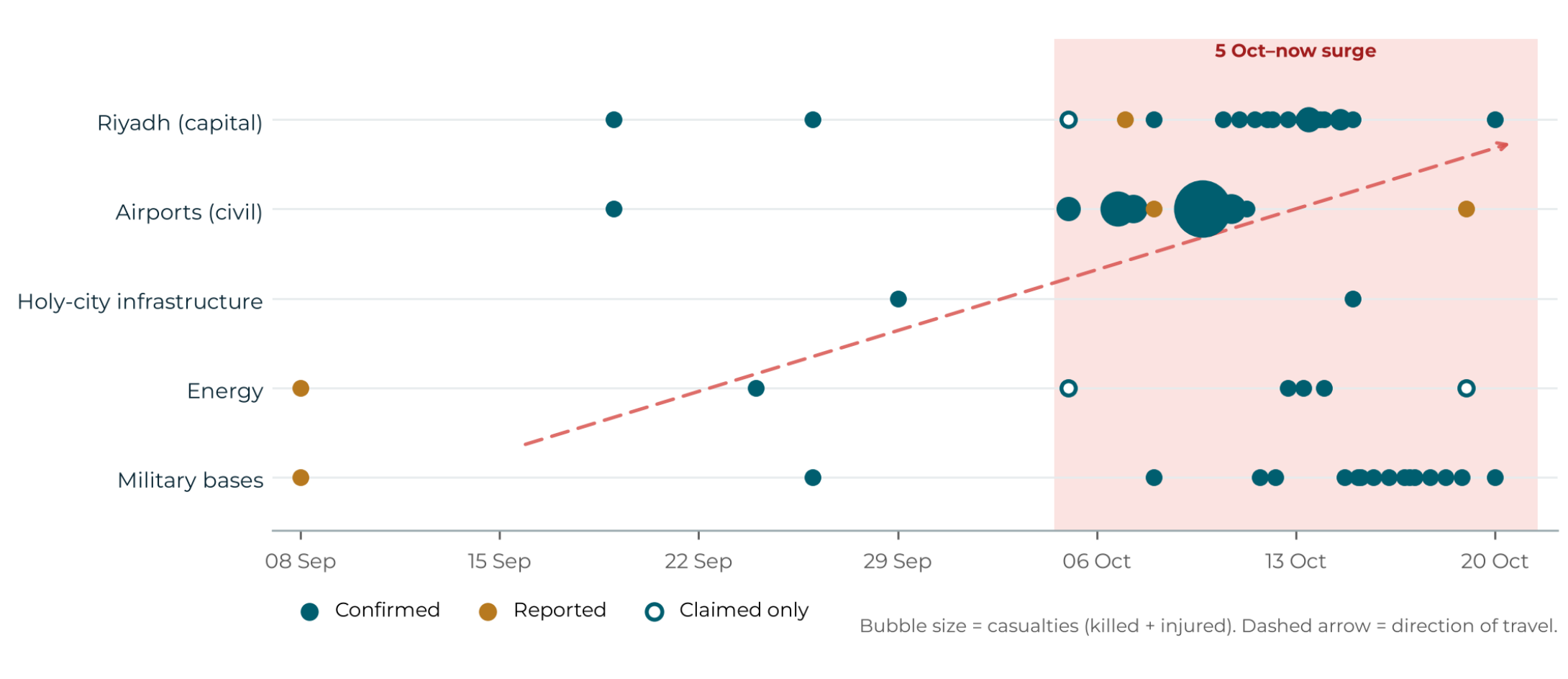
No takeoff or landing since 3:58 AM (116 min).

42	0/0	0
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct (13,470 min at 6:00 AM); delayed Saudia SV982 to Hong Kong took off at 3:02 AM and non-airline HZA8 at 4:33 AM, no landings since 7:51 PM
- Dammam halted since 3:58 AM (122 min, overnight lull) after 3 landings and no takeoffs since 3:00 AM
- No new attack on Saudi Arabia reported since 9 PM
- Saudi ambassador Al Jaber: the Kingdom will protect its people, security and territory (SABA, 4:20 AM)
- UN calls for aid access to Houthi-besieged Taiz (Al Ekhbariya, 3:39 AM)

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 21 OCT



54 sourced events since 8 September (46 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed over the Riyadh region (20 Oct, Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA; none reported). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

2

ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 3:00 AM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

No new attacks, interceptions or alerts since 3:00 AM AST.

Last 24 hours: Interceptions 3, alerts 1, all-clears 1.

3

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

No new attack on Saudi Arabia since 9 PM; Saudi envoy vows to protect the Kingdom; Riyadh still halted after two delayed overnight departures

Checked at 5:58 AM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED **Aden: growing numbers of people displaced fleeing Houthi fire**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **5:23 AM** · published 5:23 AM AST Wed 21 Oct (Saudi state TV, translated from Arabic); checked 5:58 AM

Saudi state channel Al Ekhbariya reported a rising number of people arriving in Aden after fleeing fire from the Houthi militia. No figures were given in the post.

CONFIRMED **Saudi ambassador to Yemen: the Kingdom will protect its people, security and territory; Taiz will not be held hostage**

Saudi Ambassador Mohammed Al Jaber via SABA (Yemeni state news agency) · **4:20 AM** · posted 4:20 AM AST Wed 21 Oct via the Yemeni Embassy in Pakistan's account quoting SABA; checked 5:58 AM

Saudi Ambassador to Yemen Mohammed Al Jaber said the Houthi militia trades on Yemenis' suffering, that Yemen does not belong to it and that Taiz will not be held hostage to its project, adding that the Kingdom will protect its people, security and territory.

CONFIRMED **UN calls for aid access to besieged Taiz; Yemen's endowments ministry calls the Houthi siege a crime**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **3:39 AM** · published 3:39 AM and 4:17 AM AST Wed 21 Oct (Saudi state TV, translated from Arabic); checked 5:58 AM

Al Ekhbariya reported that the United Nations is calling for humanitarian aid to be allowed into Taiz province, which is besieged by the Houthis. Yemen's Ministry of Endowments told the channel the siege is a crime with no religious, customary or legal basis, and thanked Saudi Arabia for facilities given to Yemeni pilgrims.

UNVERIFIED **Unconfirmed reports of Houthi-Saudi border clashes near Jazan**

X account @MEBriefNews · **3:51 AM** · posted 3:51 AM AST Wed 21 Oct; described by the poster as preliminary, no Saudi or coalition confirmation and no independent outlet reporting a crossing; checked 5:58 AM

An X news account reported preliminary claims of clashes between Houthi supporters and Saudi forces along the border, raising the possibility of a crossing into Jazan. No authority has confirmed it; the only verified material is Houthi video of drone strikes on Saudi border positions in Jizan and Asir released Tuesday evening.

CONFIRMED **Yemeni armed forces say about 200 Houthi fighters neutralised and 90 vehicles destroyed or disabled**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **2:45 AM** · published 2:45 AM AST Wed 21 Oct (Saudi state TV, translated from Arabic); figures are the Yemeni forces' own, not independently verified; checked 2:56 AM

Saudi state channel Al Ekhbariya, citing Yemen's government armed forces, reported that about 200 Houthi fighters were neutralised and 90 vehicles and pieces of military equipment destroyed or disabled. No location or time frame was given in the post.

CONFIRMED **Saudi Cabinet: regional stability and freedom of navigation are an international responsibility**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **12:59 AM** · published 12:59 AM AST Wed 21 Oct in Al Ekhbariya's Tuesday roundup (translated from Arabic); checked 2:56 AM

Al Ekhbariya's roundup of Tuesday's news led with the Cabinet saying that strengthening regional stability and keeping navigation secure is an international responsibility, alongside the destruction of the launcher behind Tuesday's Riyadh missile.

CORROBORATED **UK to fly RAF Typhoon defensive air patrols over Saudi Arabia**

UK Ministry of Defence (GOV.UK); BBC, AP, Al Jazeera · **1:59 PM** · MoD update published 1:59 PM AST Tue 20 Oct; still widely reported overnight; checked 2:56 AM

Britain says RAF Typhoons will fly defensive counter-air missions to protect Saudi cities and infrastructure from Houthi missiles and drones, without striking Houthi targets. It is also sending an A400M transport aircraft and advisers and extending air-to-air refuelling by 90 days.

UNVERIFIED **Footage circulating of travellers panicking at Riyadh airport after an explosion sound**

X account @Xnews_I · **11:22 PM** · posted 11:22 PM AST Tue 20 Oct; date and location of the video not verified, no official report of a new incident at the airport; checked 11:58 PM

An X account posted video it says shows panic among travellers at King Khalid International Airport after the sound of an explosion. The date of the footage is not confirmed and no Saudi authority has reported a new incident tonight.

CONFIRMED **Coalition releases footage of tracking and striking the launcher behind Tuesday's ballistic missile at Riyadh**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox); SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **10:25 PM** · published 10:25 PM AST (Arabic), SPA English 10:47 PM; also Al Ekhbariya 10:29 PM; checked 11:58 PM

The coalition published video it says shows its forces tracking and destroying the Houthi launch platform used for the ballistic missile fired at Riyadh on Tuesday, following its 8:06 PM statement.

CLAIM **Houthi media claim drone hits on Saudi soldiers in Jizan and Asir**

Houthi War Media video, reported on X (@realmaxmorgan) · **10:07 PM** · posted 10:07 PM AST Tue 20 Oct; not independently verified, no Saudi comment; checked 11:58 PM

Houthi War Media released a video it says shows drone strikes on Saudi soldiers in Jizan and Asir. Claims of 40+ killed are unverified and Saudi authorities have not commented.

CONFIRMED **Riyadh airport tells travellers to follow official authorities for airspace updates and contact their airline**

King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) · **9:33 PM** · published 9:33 PM AST (English reply), repeated in Arabic 10:52 PM; checked 11:58 PM

Replying to passengers, the airport's official account said that for the latest airspace updates they should follow the relevant official authorities and contact the airline they booked with. It gave no reopening date.

UNVERIFIED **Islamic foreign ministers condemn Houthi aggression on Saudi Arabia**

Saudi Gazette (@Saudi_Gazette) · **8:30 PM** · published 8:30 PM AST Tue 20 Oct; single newspaper report, statement text not yet checked; checked 8:53 PM

Saudi Gazette reports that foreign ministers of Islamic countries condemned the Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia.

CONFIRMED **Saudi and Kuwaiti foreign ministers condemn continuing Houthi attacks on civilian areas in the Kingdom**

SPA (@SPAregions) · **8:22 PM** · published 8:22 PM AST Tue 20 Oct (official account, translated from Arabic); checked 8:53 PM

SPA says the Saudi Foreign Minister and Kuwait's Foreign Minister discussed regional developments by phone and condemned the continuing attacks by the Houthi militia on civilian areas in the Kingdom, stressing the two countries' solidarity.

4

KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (13465 min).

120
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY
53 departures + 67 arrivals, 19% of 634 scheduled.

4:33 AM
LAST TAKEOFF
HZA8 to Heraklion (non-airline flight), 81 min before 5:54 AM. Last airline: SV982, 3:02 AM.

7:51 PM
LAST LANDING
SV979 from Guangzhou, 603 min before 5:54 AM.

0
TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR
0 landings in the last hour.

4
ARRIVALS DIVERTED
Mostly to Jeddah, Dammam.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 5:54 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 114 at 5:55 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	53	67	120	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	50 (16%)	64 (20%)	114	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	1 (0%)	0 (0%)	1	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	3 (75%)	0 (0%)	3	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	48 min	0 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	3 of 50	0 of 48	3 of 98	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	4	4	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	32	32	64	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	175	180	355	FR24 stats panel

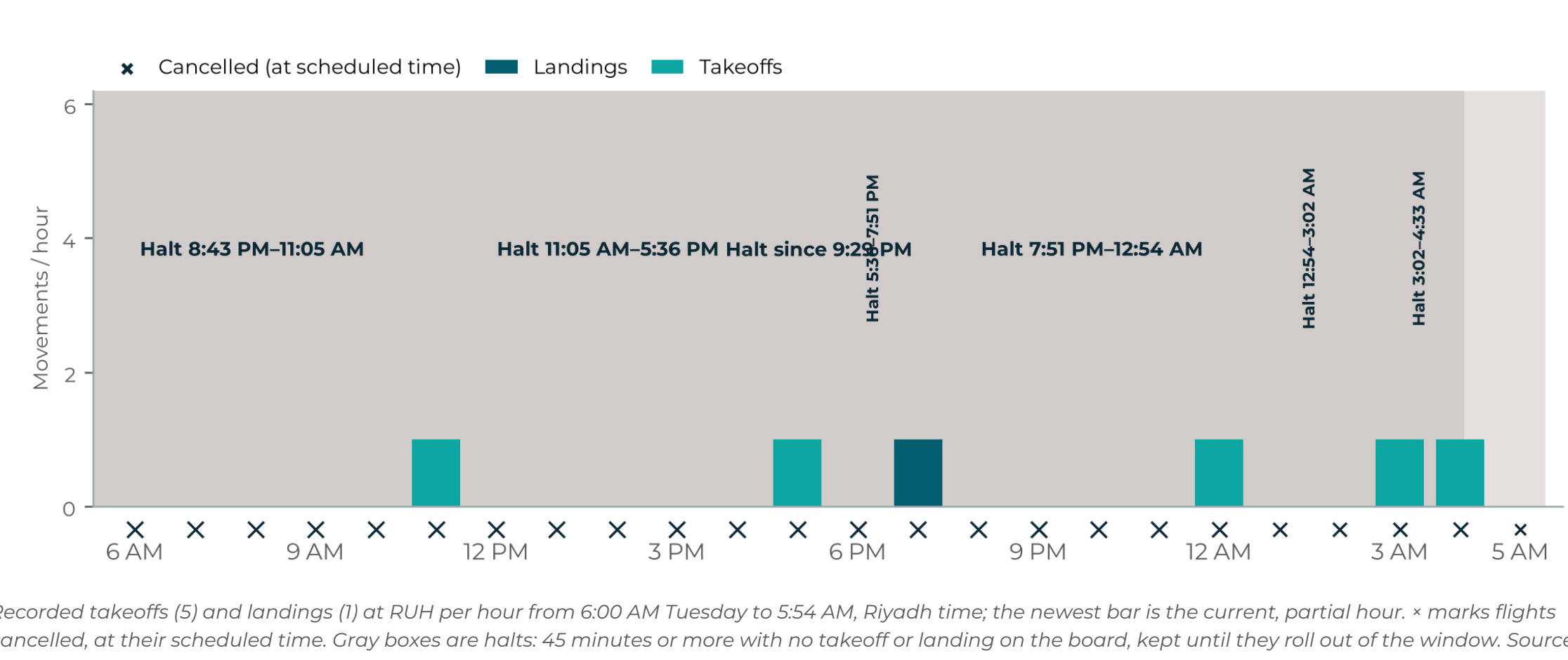
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Saudia	53
Gulf Air	10
flynas	7
flyadeal	7
Emirates	6

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Madinah	18
Dubai	12
Bahrain	12
Jeddah	11
Cairo	9

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



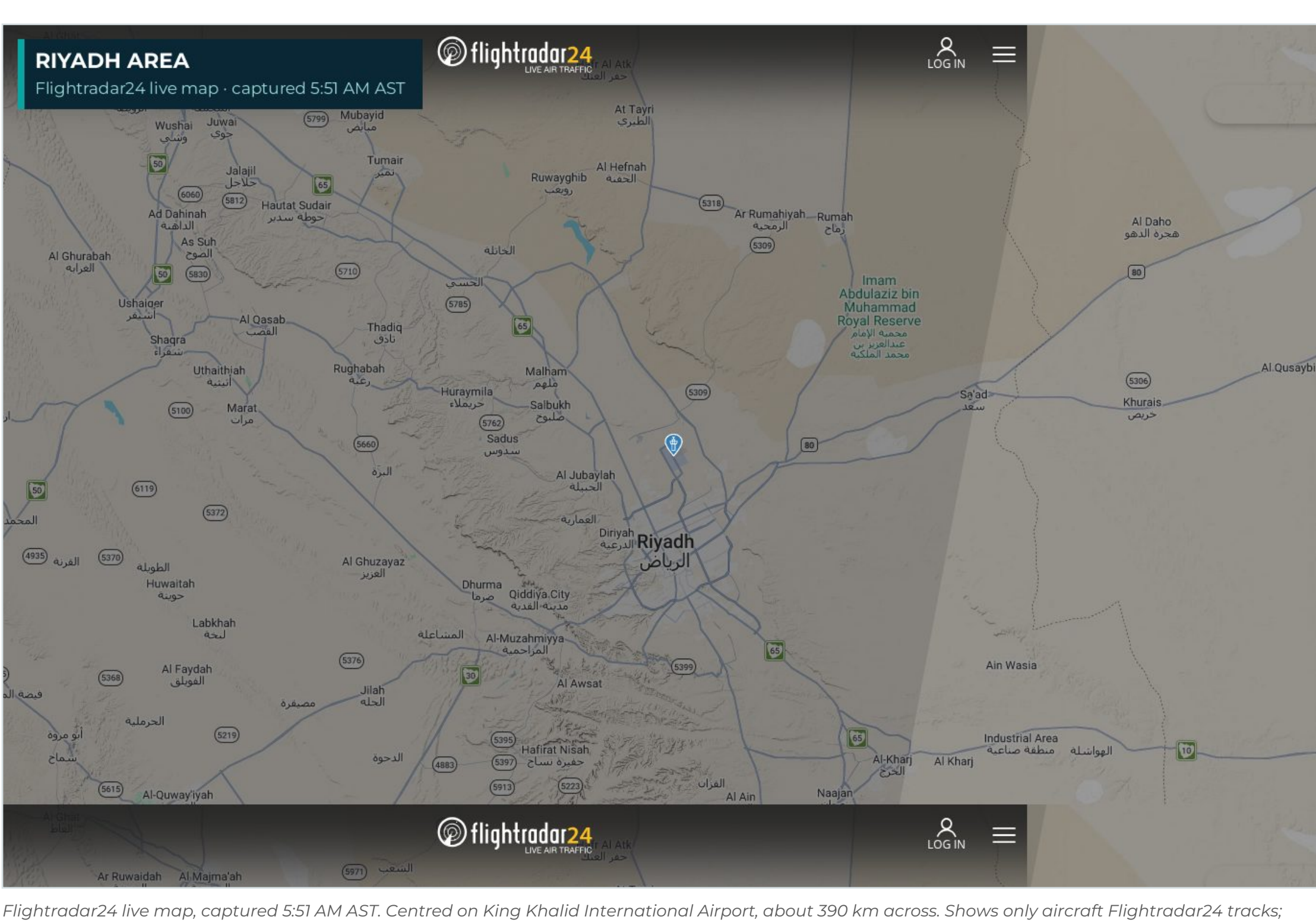
Recorded takeoffs (5) and landings (1) at RUH per hour from 6:00 AM Tuesday to 5:54 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct covers the whole window; the only Riyadh movements in it are delayed or non-scheduled flights: takeoffs HZSK5 to Geneva 11:05 AM and 0S2828 to Milan 5:36 PM Tuesday, Saudia SV992 12:54 AM, Saudia SV982 3:02 AM and HZA8 4:33 AM Wednesday, and the landing Saudia SV979 at 7:51 PM Tuesday. Dammam's halts in the window ran 7:43–8:37 PM Tuesday, 1:45–2:55 AM, and since 3:58 AM Wednesday (open).

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 3:02–4:33 AM	91 min
Halt 12:54–3:02 AM	128 min
Halt 7:51 PM–12:54 AM	303 min
Halt 5:36–7:51 PM	135 min
Halt 11:05 AM–5:36 PM	391 min

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 5:51 AM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

5

KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

Dammam airport: disrupted. No takeoff or landing since 3:58 AM (116 min).

42
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY
20 departures + 22 arrivals, 19% of 227 scheduled.

1:45 AM
LAST TAKEOFF
XY896 to Lucknow, 249 min before 5:54 AM.

3:58 AM
LAST LANDING
G9160 from Sharjah, 116 min before 5:54 AM.

0
TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR
0 landings in the last hour.

0
ARRIVALS DIVERTED
None recorded today.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 5:54 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 41 at 5:55 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	20	22	42	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	19 (16%)	22 (20%)	41	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	2 (2%)	2 (2%)	4	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	7 (78%)	5 (71%)	12	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	0 min	5 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	7 of 18	6 of 18	13 of 36	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	0	0	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	1	6	7	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	32	32	64	FR24 stats panel

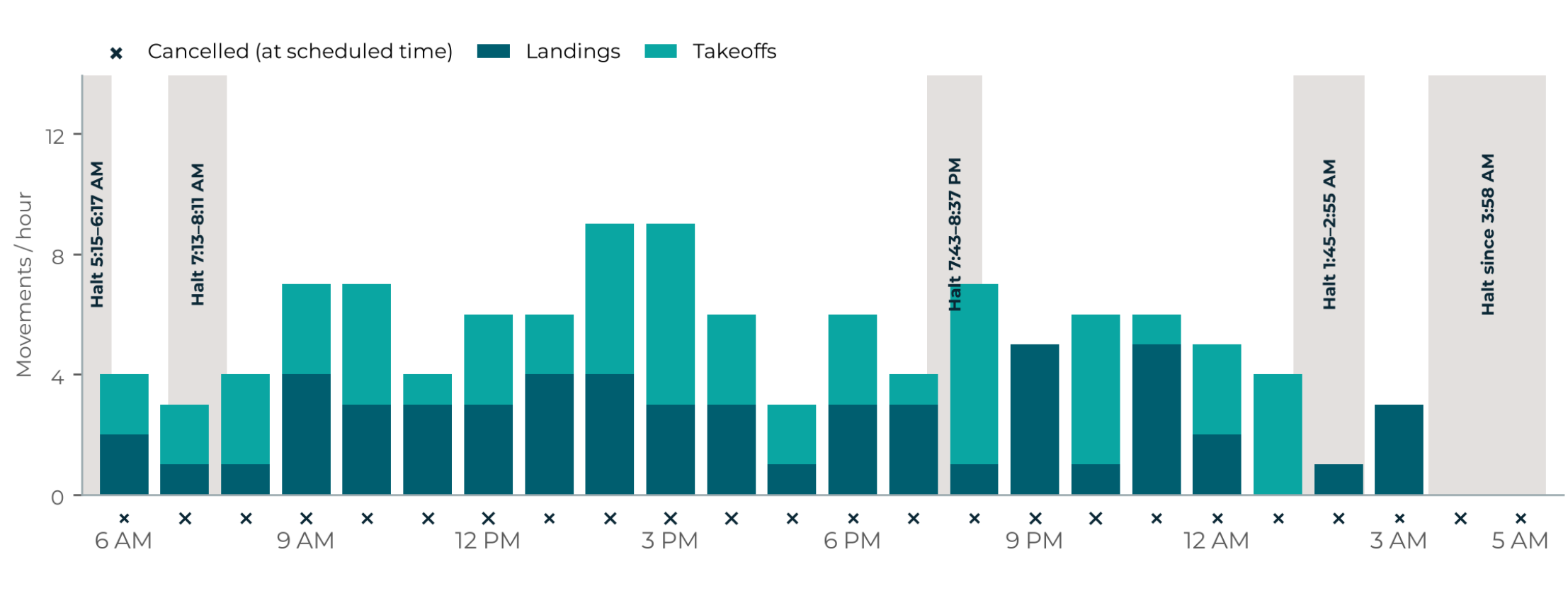
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Egyptair	8
Etihad Airways	8
flydubai	8
Emirates	6
Saudia	5

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Dubai	14
Abu Dhabi	8
Cairo	6
Riyadh	5
Madinah	3

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (59) and landings (56) at DMM per hour from 6:00 AM Tuesday to 5:54 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Halted since 1:45 AM (75 min at 3:00 AM): 7 takeoffs and 2 landings since midnight, none in the last hour.

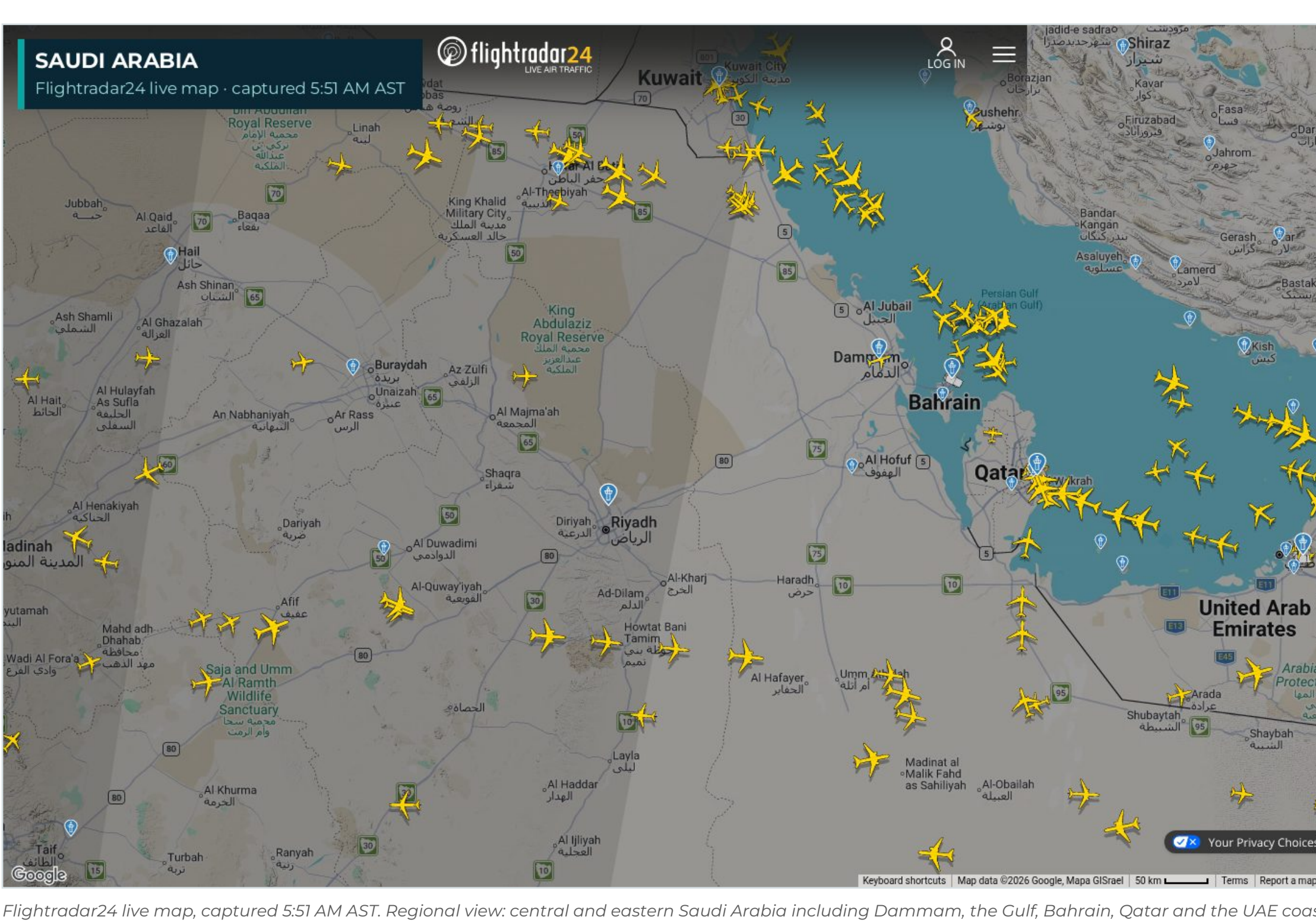
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

OPEN Halt since 3:58 AM	116 min and counting
Halt 1:45–2:55 AM	70 min
Halt 7:43–8:37 PM	54 min
Halt 7:13–8:11 AM	58 min
Halt 5:15–6:17 AM	62 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

No Dammam airport-specific statement or credible report found in this edition's news check (5:58 AM).

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 5:51 AM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

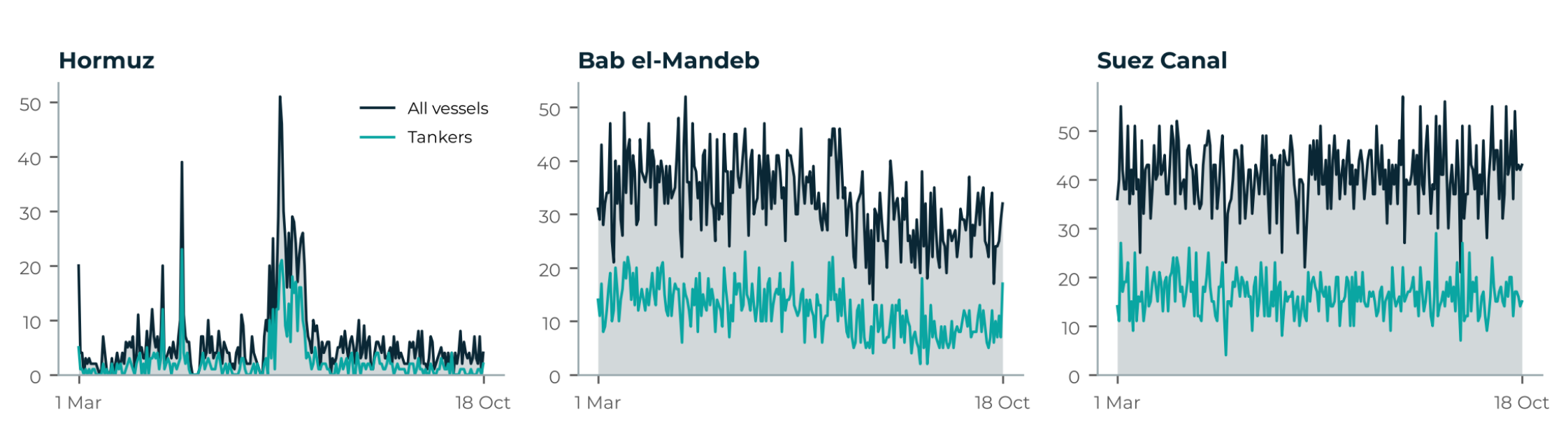
6

ECONOMY

Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

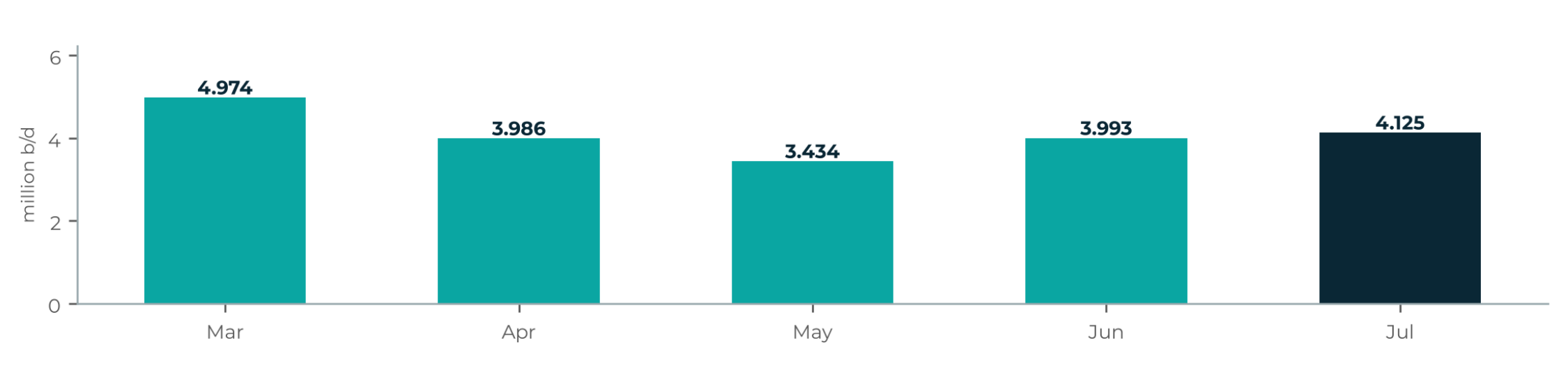
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 18 Oct	**4**	2	2	3.7 (4.1)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 18 Oct	**32**	17	15	26.4 (28.3)
Suez Canal	Sun 18 Oct	**43**	15	28	44.3 (41.7)



Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. ***Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.*** *Fetched 5:55 AM, Wed 21 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)



Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

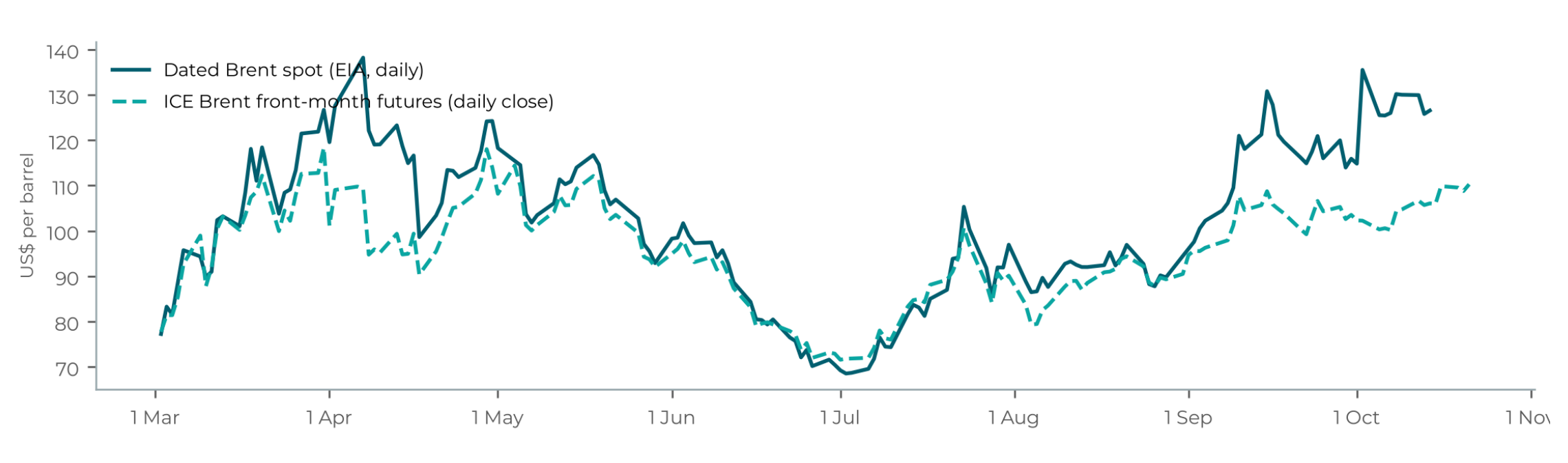
BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$110.27
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST
ICE front-month, 5:45 AM, Wed 21 Oct AST (+1.4% on day). Near real time.

$126.55
DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)
Wed 14 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.

+4%
SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE
From $121.25 on Mon 14 Sep.

+64%
SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

7

METHOD AND LIMITS

What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 5:54 AM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
5:54 AM, Wed 21 Oct	5:54 AM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	RUH Halted · DMM Disrupted	Open sources · not official	9:00 AM

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 9:00 AM